



LME KNITTING PATTERN

BUCKET HATS FOR BABY AND CHILD

NORGE · NORWAY · RO · SIZE 50-170

The same bucket hat as the NORGE and RO patterns for adults, graded completely from scratch into twenty-one baby, child and teen sizes, 50 to 170. Smaller letters and a small flag motif were designed just for the smallest heads. This pattern is complete on its own, you do not need any other LME pattern to knit it.



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TIPS: Read the whole pattern once before you cast on. Always knit a gauge swatch first, see page 4.

BEFORE YOU START

The bucket hat is knitted in the round on a circular needle or double-pointed needles, from the bottom up. You start with a striped brim that flares, then the main body straight up with the motif in the middle, and finally decrease the crown down to a small rounded top. This pattern covers three motifs, pick the one you want to make:

- **NORGE:** the word knitted in white across the forehead
- **NORWAY:** the same, but with the English name
- **RO:** the RO letters plus a small Norwegian flag, solid blue brim

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit a hat in the round on a circular needle or double-pointed needles
- To knit a striped, flared brim with a decrease round
- To place and knit a small letter or flag motif from a chart
- To decrease a rounded crown evenly down to a few stitches

HOW HARD IS IT?

Beginner friendly. You should be able to cast on, knit stockinette in the round and change colour. The motif is knitted with only two colours at a time, and every step is spelled out in this pattern.

Use double-pointed needles or magic loop for the smallest sizes (50-86). An ordinary circular needle is often too long for the stitches to reach round.

SIZES AND GETTING THE FIT RIGHT

The clothing size is only a guide. Always measure around the child's head, above the ears and eyebrows. Go by the head measurement if it and the clothing size point to different sizes.

Size	Approx. age	Head (cm)
50	0-1 mo	34-36
56	1-2 mo	36-38
62	2-4 mo	38-40
68	4-6 mo	40-42
74	6-9 mo	42-44
80	9-12 mo	44-46
86	12-18 mo	46-48
92	18-24 mo	48-50
98	2-3 yr	49-51
104	3-4 yr	50-52
110	4-5 yr	51-53
116	5-6 yr	52-53
122	6-7 yr	52-54
128	7-8 yr	53-54
134	8-9 yr	53-55
140	9-10 yr	54-55
146	10-11 yr	54-56
152	11-12 yr	55-56
158	12-13 yr	55-57
164	13-14 yr	56-57
170	14-16 yr	56-58

SAFE USE FOR THE YOUNGEST

The hat is a garment for supervised, awake use. It should not be used during sleep, in a cot, in a pram unattended, or if the brim covers the eyes, nose or mouth. Always check that no loose threads or long floats on the inside can catch on little fingers.

Children grow at different rates. The actual head measurement always beats age, measure again whenever you are unsure.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

A smooth cotton yarn (aran weight) that gives 17 stitches x 22 rounds in stockinette = 10 x 10 cm on 5 mm needles. Reynolds Saucy, Rico Design Creative Cotton Aran and Hobbii Amigo are all good choices, in red, white and navy.

Colour

Use

● Red	main colour
○ White	letters, stripes
● Navy	stripes, flag, RO brim

Have plenty of red main colour (almost the whole hat) and one small ball each of white and navy, they are only used in the brim and the motif.

NEEDLES AND KIT

- 5 mm circular needle, 40 cm, or 5 mm double-pointed needles/magic loop set
- Tapestry needle, scissors and tape measure
- Stitch marker (optional, to track centre front)

**If you knit tightly, try 5.5 mm needles. If you knit loosely, try 4.5 mm.
The target is always 17 stitches over 10 cm.**

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

KNIT A SWATCH FIRST

Cast on 30 stitches in the main colour. Knit stockinette in the round (or back and forth with an edge) until the swatch is at least 12 x 12 cm. Wash and dry it the way you plan to treat the hat, then measure across the middle.

- More than 17 stitches over 10 cm: try a thicker needle.
- Fewer than 17 stitches over 10 cm: try a thinner needle.
- Exactly 17 stitches: use 5 mm needles and get going.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
round	one whole lap around
k	knit
k2tog	knit 2 stitches together, decreases one stitch
MC	main colour (red)
float	the thread that runs on the inside when the colour is not in use
evenly spaced	spread equally around the round, not bunched in one spot

PART 1: CAST ON AND KNIT THE BRIM

- 1 Find the number for your size in the «Cast on» column in the table on the next page. Cast on exactly that many stitches in red main colour.
- 2 Check that the cast-on edge is not twisted around the needle. Join in the round and place a stitch marker at the start of the round, this is where every round begins and ends.
- 3 Knit the brim in stockinette in the round (knit every stitch), for the number of rounds in the «Brim rounds» column. Change colour following the stripe suggestion in the table: knit each stripe for the stated number of rounds before switching to the next colour.
- 4 RO hat: skip the stripes and knit the whole brim in navy instead.
- 5 On the very last brim round, knit 2 stitches together all the way round (stitch 1 and 2 together, stitch 3 and 4 together, and so on). This halves the stitch count exactly, from your cast-on number down to the «Main body» number on the next page.

THE FLARED EDGE

The decrease round is what gives the brim its characteristic flared, wavy edge, it is normal for the edge to curl in a little until the hat has been worn a few times.

TABLE: THE BRIM, ALL SIZES

Size	Cast on	Brim rounds	Stripe order (NORGE/NORWAY)
50	116	6	2 red, 1 white, 1 blue, 1 white, rest red
56	122	7	2 red, 1 white, 1 blue, 1 white, rest red
62	130	8	2 red, 2 white, 2 blue, 1 white, rest red
68	136	9	2 red, 2 white, 2 blue, 1 white, rest red
74	144	10	2 red, 2 white, 2 blue, 1 white, rest red
80	150	11	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
86	156	12	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
92	162	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
98	166	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
104	170	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
110	172	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
116	174	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
122	176	14	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
128	178	14	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
134	178	14	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
140	180	15	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
146	182	15	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
152	184	15	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
158	186	15	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
164	188	16	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
170	190	16	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red

Use double-pointed needles or magic loop for the whole brim on the smallest sizes, it is too narrow for an ordinary circular needle.

PART 2: THE MAIN BODY

- 1 After the decrease round, knit stockinette in the round in the main colour. This is now the main body of the hat, the part that shows the most.
- 2 Knit plain, no pattern, until the work measures about half of the «Height to top» value in the table on the next page, this is where the motif should begin.
- 3 Knit your motif in here, see Part 3 on the next spread.
- 4 Continue plain in the main colour after the motif until the whole main body measures the «Height to top» value, measured from the decrease round.

TABLE: MAIN BODY

Size	Stitches (main body)	Height to top
50	58	5.5 cm
56	61	6 cm
62	65	6.5 cm
68	68	7 cm
74	72	7.5 cm
80	75	8 cm
86	78	8.5 cm
92	81	9 cm
98	83	9 cm
104	85	9 cm
110	86	9.5 cm
116	87	9.5 cm
122	88	10 cm
128	89	10 cm
134	89	10.5 cm
140	90	10.5 cm
146	91	10.5 cm
152	92	11 cm
158	93	11 cm
164	94	11 cm
170	95	11 cm

The motif should sit in the middle of the main body height, not right down against the brim and not right up at the top.

PART 3: THE MOTIF

The motifs are knitted in white or navy on a red background, using stranded colourwork (fair isle): you knit with two colours in the same round and let the unused colour float loosely on the inside.

HOW TO PLACE THE MOTIF

Count the stitches around and find the middle (half of the «Main body» number), that becomes centre front, the middle of the forehead. Centre the chart around this point, with the same number of background stitches on each side.

CHART: NORGE (29 STITCHES X 7 ROUNDS)

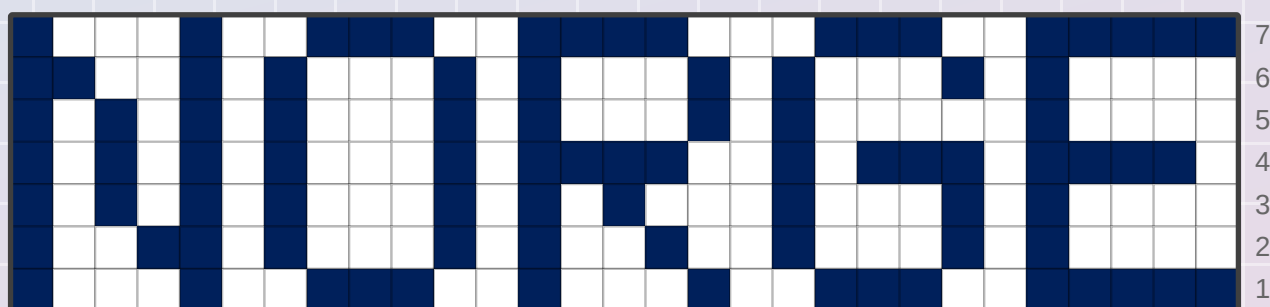


CHART: NORWAY (35 STITCHES X 7 ROUNDS)

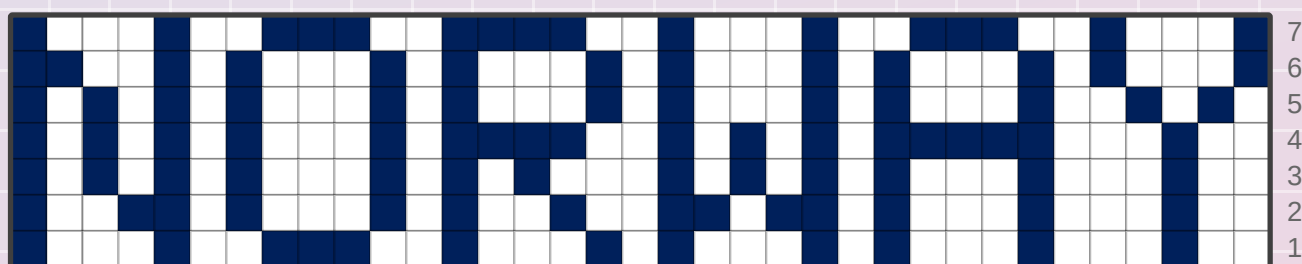
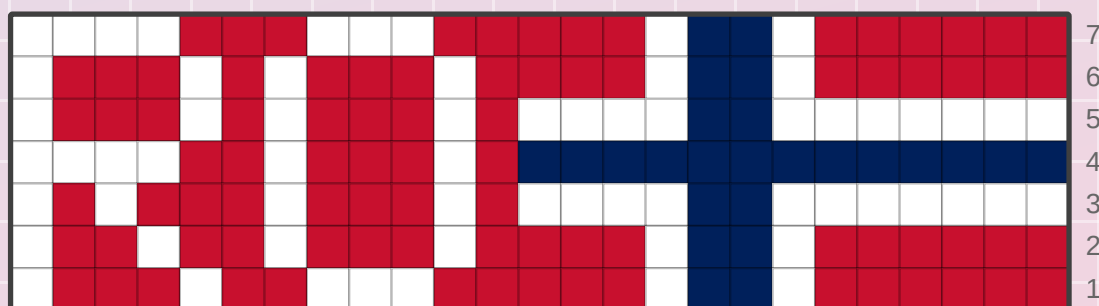


CHART: RO + FLAG (25 STITCHES X 7 ROUNDS)



Read all charts from the bottom up. Because you are knitting in the round, each round is read from right to left. White square = knit white (or navy for the RO brim). Coloured square = knit main colour.

PART 4: THE CROWN

- 1 When the main body measures the value in the table on page 8, knit one setup round: decrease the number of stitches given in the «Decrease» column in the table on the next page, evenly spaced around the whole round. If it says «No decrease», skip this round and go straight to the next step.
- 2 Divide the remaining stitches into 7 equal sections. Place a stitch marker between each section (7 markers in total, plus the one at the start of the round).
- 3 Knit to 2 stitches before each marker, knit these 2 together. Repeat at all 7 markers, giving 7 decreases per round.
- 4 Sizes 50–68: knit 1 plain round with no decreases after the first 3 decrease rounds, then decrease on every round after that. Sizes 74–170: knit 1 plain round after the first 4 decrease rounds, then decrease every round after that.
- 5 Continue until 7 stitches (one per section) remain. Cut the yarn leaving a generous tail, thread it through the remaining stitches with a tapestry needle, pull tight and fasten off securely on the inside.

TABLE: SETUP BEFORE THE CROWN, ALL SIZES

Size	Stitches before top	Decrease	Stitches after
50	58	Dec 2 st	56
56	61	Dec 5 st	56
62	65	Dec 2 st	63
68	68	Dec 5 st	63
74	72	Dec 2 st	70
80	75	Dec 5 st	70
86	78	Dec 1 st	77
92	81	Dec 4 st	77
98	83	Dec 6 st	77
104	85	Dec 1 st	84
110	86	Dec 2 st	84
116	87	Dec 3 st	84
122	88	Dec 4 st	84
128	89	Dec 5 st	84
134	89	Dec 5 st	84
140	90	Dec 6 st	84
146	91	No decrease	91
152	92	Dec 1 st	91
158	93	Dec 2 st	91
164	94	Dec 3 st	91
170	95	Dec 4 st	91

CARE AND FINAL CHECK

FINISHING

Weave in all loose ends securely on the inside, especially at the colour changes in the brim and around the motif. Check that the floats on the inside lie loose, not tight, or the hat will pull itself in.

CARE

Wash following the yarn's recommendation, often 30°C on a gentle cycle in a wash bag, or by hand. Do not tumble dry. Shape the hat over a bowl or glass of the right size and let it dry flat or on the form.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ The head measurement has been checked, not just age
- ☐ The swatch matches 17 stitches x 22 rounds over 10 cm
- ☐ The brim has the flared edge from the decrease round
- ☐ The motif is centred at centre front
- ☐ All floats on the inside lie loose
- ☐ The top is pulled tight and well fastened off

Congratulations, you have knitted your very own kids' bucket hat!



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The hat is a garment for supervised, awake use. Do not use during sleep or in a pram unattended.